

ROOTS

CULTURE / PEOPLE / PLACES

Where we
belong.

A GARDEN
IN THE CITY

People, place
and possibility

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SMALL RITUALS
THAT SHAPE A LIFE

PORTRAITS / MEMORY / EVERYDAY CREATIVITY

THE GARDEN ISSUE / 01 / 2026

People. Place. Possibility.

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Small rituals, lasting roots

The ordinary gestures that keep us connected.

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Portraits of belonging

Illustration, identity and the creative life.

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A garden in the city

Finding a slower rhythm in shared green space.

An independent magazine about the people and places that make everyday life meaningful.

Small rituals, lasting roots.

WORDS / THE ROOTS EDITORIAL DESK

Belonging is made in small moments. A meal prepared in a familiar way, a song carried into a new city, a greeting passed between generations: each gives an ordinary day a thread of continuity. These gestures are easy to overlook because they rarely ask for attention. Yet they shape the way we recognise home.

A ritual does not need to be elaborate to matter. Its power comes from repetition and care. We return to the same gesture because it reminds us who we are, where we have been and who has made room for us. The rhythm becomes a quiet form of memory.

Place changes us, too. A street can teach us a new pace. A market can introduce us to a different way of sharing a meal. A garden can

give us a reason to pause beside a stranger. Familiar habits meet new surroundings, and something unexpected begins to grow. There is no single way to belong. Some people find it in a language, others in a craft, a community or the work of caring for a shared space. What matters is the invitation to participate. A place becomes ours when we contribute to its everyday life.

Creative practice can make these connections visible. Through colour, portraiture and storytelling, we notice the details that connect an individual experience to a wider culture. An image can leave room for complexity without turning it into a problem to

solve.

The stories in this issue begin with attention: to the ordinary, to the people beside us and to the landscapes that hold our lives. Roots are not only inherited. They are made, one thoughtful act at a time.



More than one story.

Identity moves between places, languages and generations. A portrait can hold that movement without trying to resolve it. The shape of a face, the fall of fabric and a familiar gesture tell us something about a person. What remains outside the frame matters, too.

A PORTRAIT OF POSSIBILITY



Colour gives the image its rhythm. Warm coral and deep green create a conversation between people and landscape.

We look for a visual language that makes room for difference, rather than asking every story to fit the same frame.



A garden in the city.

A small green space changes the pace of a street. Shade creates a place to pause. Familiar faces make the pause a habit.

A garden becomes more than a landscape when people make it part of their daily life. Its value is measured in conversations, care and time spent together.

Belonging begins
with attention.

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Keep growing.

Independent culture. Shared perspectives.
The next chapter starts with a conversation.